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Mercury

FIRST TECH CHALLENGE 26413

Sponsorship Package

2026-27

Weston, Massachusetts

About Us

GNCE Mercury (FTC Team 26413) is a student-led high school robotics team based in Weston, Massachusetts. Founded in 2024, our team consists of 10 student members supported by 4 volunteer coaches. Each competition season, our students design, prototype, fabricate, code, and test a fully functional competitive robot. Beyond competition, our team leads community STEM outreach: we mentor local Weston FIRST LEGO League teams, host annual STEM summer camps, and provide remote technical mentorship to an emerging robotics team in South Africa.



Andy Ding
Co-Captain



Arnie Sreeram
Co-Captain



Zade Parks
CAD Lead



Ethan Xie
Build & Electrical Lead



Margaret Yang
Head of Sponsorship



Reynah Chowrira
Outreach Lead



Avo Bell
CAD



Tucker Cashel
Build



Kai Kassekert
CAD & Build



Ashna Sreeram
CAD & Website

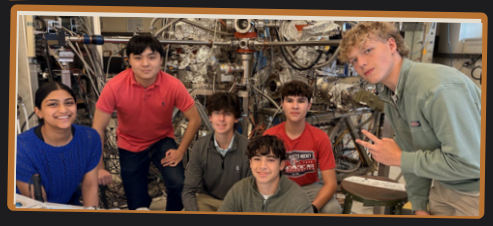
What is FTC?

The FIRST Tech Challenge (FTC) is an international student robotics challenge organized by FIRST, a non-profit STEM education organization. Every season, middle and high school student teams collaborate to design, manufacture, and program an autonomous and driver-controlled robot to complete an annually released challenge, competing in strategic alliances against other teams.

Tours and Visits

Our team actively organizes industry tours to engineering firms and research laboratories, allowing our student engineers to observe real-world professional engineering workflows. If your organization is open to hosting a student site visit, we would greatly welcome the opportunity.





Touring VulcanForms and MIT's Francis Bitter Magnet Lab

Our Student Leaders

Andy Ding 4th year in FTC

- Qualified for Massachusetts States
- FIRST Dean's List Semifinalist
- 1st place Inspire Award and winning alliance captain at the New England Invitational, an international event

Arnie Sreeram 4th year in FTC

- Synergy Award, Multinational Tech Invitational
- Control Award, 1st place, Michiana Premier Event

Zade Parks 3rd year in FTC

- Qualified for Massachusetts States
- First pick on the winning alliance at the Ryken RoboBowl

Ethan Xie 3rd year in FTC

- Qualified for Massachusetts States
- First pick on the winning alliance at the Ryken RoboBowl

Margaret Yang Rookie in FTC

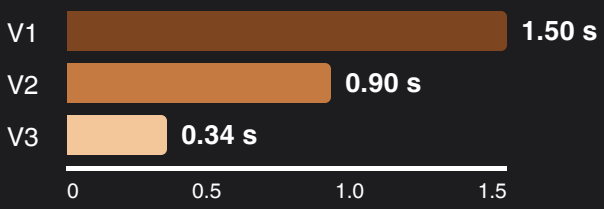
- Experience building and competing with VEX V5
- Leads sponsor outreach for the 2026-27 season

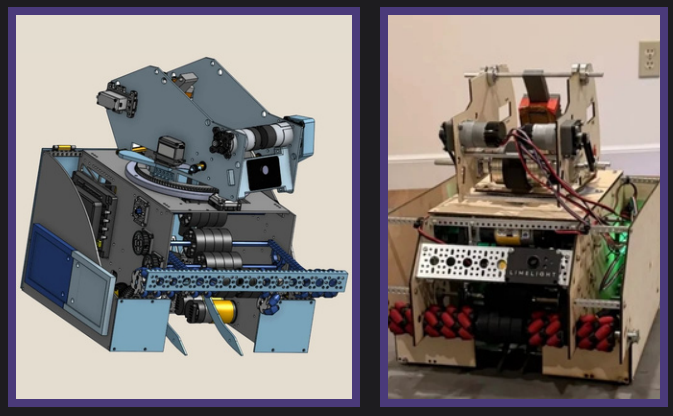
Engineering & Outreach

Our 2025-26 Robot

Our DECODE robot sends balls straight from the intake to a flywheel shooter on a turret, with a camera keeping it aimed at the goal. In autonomous, it scores **12** balls.

Transfer time, by version (seconds)





Last season's robot in CAD and this season's Mercinator

Coaching Weston FLL Teams

In 2025-26 we helped Weston's FIRST LEGO League program grow from 4 to 17 teams. Money from our summer camp paid registration fees for **10 new 4th- and 5th-grade teams** at Field School. We ran a practice scrimmage for them and mentored their coaches and students all season.



4 → 17	122	10	2
Weston FLL teams	elementary and middle schoolers	new teams our camp paid for	new teams reached States

Summer Camp

In August 2026, 13 students in grades 4 to 8 built VEX IQ and FLL robots at our one-week camp. The camp inspired many VEX teams to start.

Mentoring Other Teams

We meet by video call with students at Phuthanang Youth Trust in Soweto, South Africa, to help them start in FTC. We also mentor Galactic Einsteins and have joined their showcase at Clark University.

> *"The FLL season for the elementary teams would not have been a success if not for the support and guidance from the high school FTC 26413 team.*
>
> Jessie Chan
> Lead Coach, Field School FLL





Our Phuthanang Youth Trust partnership and summer camp showcase

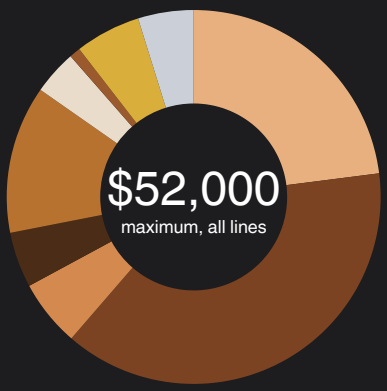
Sponsorship Tiers

Our tiers for the 2026-27 season are below; amounts are per season. To fund a specific need, or to donate parts, fabrication, or mentoring time, email **margaret@mercury26413.org**.

	Bronze ($500+)	Silver ($1,500+)	Gold ($3,000+)	Platinum ($7,500+)
Name and link on our website	✓	✓	✓	✓
Quarterly financial report	✓	✓	✓	✓
Company logo on our website	✓	✓	✓	✓
Logo on our robot and team pit	-	2 × 2 in	3 × 3 in	4 × 4 in
Thank-you post on Instagram	-	Grouped	Individual	Pinned post
Logo on team jersey	-	✓	✓	✓
End-of-season update	-	-	✓	✓
Can request media	-	-	-	✓
Private robot demonstration	-	-	-	✓

Season Budget

Sponsorship funds cover **robot parts and tools**, **registration and travel**, and our **summer camp and FLL coaching**. Competition travel is contingent on our team's qualification for events. Sponsors will receive a quarterly **financial report.**



Robot parts and electronics	Up to $11,950	23%
Travel	Up to $19,950	38%
Field and game elements	Up to $3,000	6%
Outreach and team shirts	Up to $2,500	5%
Competition & event fees	Up to $6,650	13%
Tools and machinery	Up to $2,000	4%
FIRST registration	Up to $500	1%
Growth	Up to $2,950	5%
Marketing and media	Up to $2,500	5%

Contact Us

Please send an email to margaret@mercury26413.org
Our team will respond promptly to discuss sponsorship opportunities, in-kind donations, or on-site robot demonstrations.
Website: mercury26413.org
Instagram: @gnce_mercury